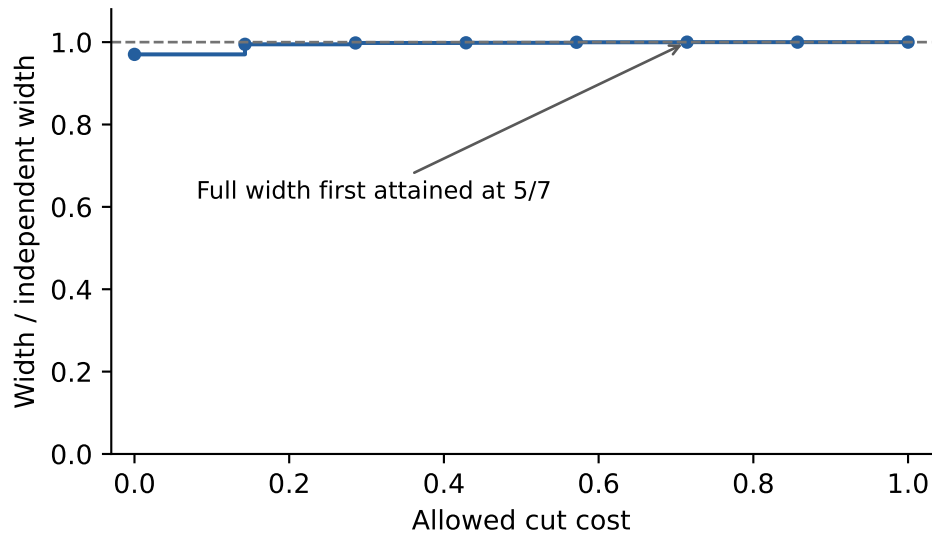


Frozen stochastic diffusion benchmark: 8 levels, 4 integration pathways

(a) Directional width budget profile



(b) Verified minimum-cost chain cut



Dashed red: removed edge; solid blue: retained edge

All extremizer lists are singletons: the cut is predetermined.